

ECONOMICS

INTRODUCTION

Economics is about how individuals, governments, and firms make choices about the allocation of scarce resources. It involves an understanding of various economic concepts, models, and theories as well as an exploration of economic trends, policies, and practices. Through economic inquiry, students develop their understanding of a range of economic issues, the interests and influence of different stakeholders, and the factors that influence the economic decisions of individuals and institutions.

Strands

The Grade 11 and 12 economics courses each have five strands. In all of these courses, strand A, Economic Inquiry and Skill Development, is followed by four content strands, which are organized thematically.

Citizenship Education

The expectations in the Grade 11 and 12 economics courses provide opportunities for students to explore a number of concepts connected to the citizenship education framework (see page 13).

The Concepts of Economic Thinking

The four concepts of economic thinking – economic significance, cause and effect, stability and variability, and economic perspective – underpin thinking and learning in all economics courses in the Canadian and world studies program. At least one concept of economic thinking is identified as the focus for each overall expectation in strands B–E of these courses. The following chart describes each concept and provides sample questions related to it. These questions highlight opportunities for students to apply a specific concept in their studies. (See page 16 for a fuller discussion of the concepts of disciplinary thinking.)

Economic Significance
This concept requires students to determine the importance of economic policies, decisions, practices, issues, trends, theories, and/or developments. Economic significance is generally determined by the impact that such policies, decisions, and so on, have on individuals, groups, institutions, and/or nations. As they explore how scarce economic resources are allocated, students come to understand that the impact of those allocations may be different for different groups. Related Questions* – What impact has the moving of production from Canada to offshore locations had on Canadian manufacturing and the communities where such industries were located? (CIE3M, E3.1) – What factors might a government consider when deciding how to allocate funding for infrastructure development? How significant would the impact on the economy be as a criterion? (CIA4U, D2.1) – What impact does scarcity have on your own and others' economic decisions? (CIC4E, Overview) – What impact would an increase in the minimum wage have on the working poor in Ontario? (CIC4E, E1.1)
Cause and Effect
This concept requires students to determine factors that affect or contribute to economic policies, decisions, practices, trends, and/or developments as well as the consequences of these policies, decisions, and so on. Students develop an understanding of the complexity of causes and effects, learning that something may be caused by more than one factor and may have many consequences, both intended and unintended. Related Questions – Why have some manufacturing and services moved to Asia in the past few decades? (CIE3M, E2.3) – Why might the federal government consider raising Employment Insurance (EI) premiums? How might such a policy affect firms and workers? (CIA4U, D2.4) – How do the effects of economic marginalization contribute to its perpetuation? (CIA4U, E3.1) – What factors have the biggest influence on your own credit rating? Are there financial decisions that you have made or are facing now that might affect your credit rating? Why is it important to consider the long-term consequences of these decisions? (CIC4E, B2.3)

* The “related questions” are drawn directly from the overview charts that precede the Grade 11 and 12 economics courses and from the sample questions that accompany many specific expectations.

Stability and Variability

This concept requires students to determine how and why economic activity and/or well-being changes or stays the same over time. Students analyse various economic indicators related to employment, trade, markets, economic inequality, and/or government intervention in the economy to identify changes in different communities, regions, and countries over time. They also investigate various factors that contribute to economic change and/or help ensure stability.

Related Questions

- What is the role of taxation in the Canadian economy? (CIE3M, Overview)
- Where would you position the present Canadian economy on the business cycle? What are the implications of its position? (CIE3M, B2.3)
- What are the implications of what “counts” and does not “count” in economic indicators? (CIA4U, D1.4)
- What is the purpose of allowing individuals to deduct RRSP contributions when they file their income tax returns? How might this program contribute to individual and/or governmental financial stability? (CIC4E, B3.1)

Economic Perspective

This concept requires students to analyse the beliefs, values, interests, and influence that underpin economic policies, decisions, issues, and/or practices. Students learn that, in economics, people may have diverse perspectives on the same policy or decision, and that economic policies and decisions may benefit some groups while disadvantaging others. Students also learn that economic development may have social, cultural, and environmental, as well as direct economic, effects. Students also come to understand that their own economic perspective affects their personal economic/financial decisions.

Related Questions

- What are your financial goals in the next five years? Ten years? Twenty years? In what ways do your goals differ from the short- and long-term goals of your parents and/or grandparents? (CIE3M, B4.1)
- Should Canada sell resources such as asbestos or depleted uranium to countries that could use them in an unethical manner? (CIE3M, E3.3)
- What are some ways in which economic trade-offs might differ for the average person in developing and developed countries? (CIA4U, C2.1)
- Why might different stakeholders have different perspectives on economic issues that affect the environment? (CIC4E, Overview)

The Economic Inquiry Process

In each economics course in the Canadian and world studies curriculum, strand A focuses explicitly on the economic inquiry process, guiding students in their investigation of economic issues, trends, concepts, models, policies, decisions, and outcomes. This process is *not* intended to be applied in a linear manner: students will use the applicable components of the process in the order most appropriate for them and for the task at hand. Although strand A covers all of the components of the inquiry process, it is important to note that students apply skills associated with the inquiry process throughout the content strands in each course. (See page 32 for a fuller discussion of the inquiry process in the Canadian and world studies program.)

The following chart identifies ways in which students may approach each of the components of the economic inquiry process.

Formulate Questions
Students formulate questions: – to explore various issues, developments, concepts, models, policies, and/or decisions that are related to the overall expectations in order to identify the focus of their inquiry – to help them determine which key concept (or concepts) of economic thinking is relevant to their inquiry – that reflect the selected concept(s) of economic thinking – to develop criteria that they will use in evaluating data, evidence, and/or information; in making judgements, decisions, or predictions; in reaching conclusions; and/or in solving problems – to determine which economic model it would be appropriate to apply
Gather and Organize
Students: – collect relevant qualitative and quantitative data, evidence, and/or information from a variety of primary and secondary sources,^a including community resources^b – determine if their sources are credible, accurate, and reliable – identify the purpose and intent of each source – identify the points of view in the sources they have gathered – use a variety of methods to organize the data, evidence, and/or information they have gathered – record the sources of the data, evidence, and/or information they are using – decide whether they have collected enough data, evidence, and/or information for their inquiry

a. Primary sources may include, but are not limited to, statistical data, government budgets, financial statements, interviews, and treatises by classic economic theorists. Secondary sources may include, but are not limited to, financial/business reports, books and articles based on primary sources, reference books, news articles and editorials, political cartoons, and documentaries and other films. Depending on the context, digital sources, including social media and websites, can be either primary or secondary sources.

b. Community resources may include, but are not limited to, a range of resources from community groups and associations, government offices, businesses, and non-governmental organizations.

Interpret and Analyse

Students:

- analyse data, evidence, and/or information, applying the relevant concepts of economic thinking (see preceding chart)
- use different types of tools to help them interpret and analyse their data, evidence, and/or information
- identify the key points or ideas in each source
- interpret data and representations of data (e.g., graphs, matrices, statistical tables) to help them analyse issues, policies, events, trends, and/or developments
- construct graphs, charts, and/or diagrams to help them analyse the issue, policy, event, trend, and/or development they are investigating
- analyse their sources to determine the importance of an issue, policy, and/or economic/financial decision for individuals and/or groups, including different groups
- identify biases in individual sources as well as economic models and data
- determine if all points of view are represented in the source materials as a whole, and which, if any, are missing

Evaluate and Draw Conclusions

Students:

- synthesize data, evidence, and/or information, and make informed, critical judgements based on that data, evidence, and/or information
- make connections between different factors and contexts when analysing issues, policies, decisions, trends, and developments
- determine the short- and long-term impact of issues, policies, decisions, events, and/or developments for different individuals, communities, groups, and/or regions
- assess the ethical implications of economic decisions, policies, and/or practices
- reach conclusions about the subject of their inquiry, and support them with their data, evidence, and/or information
- make predictions based on their data, evidence, and/or information

Communicate

Students:

- use appropriate forms (e.g., oral, visual, written, multimedia) for different audiences and purposes
- communicate their arguments, conclusions, and judgements clearly and logically
- use economic terminology and concepts correctly and effectively
- cite sources, using appropriate forms of documentation

Making Personal Economic Choices, Grade 12

Workplace Preparation

CIC4E

This course provides students with a fundamental understanding of a variety of key economic issues and practices, helping them develop their ability to make informed economic choices in their day-to-day lives. Students will examine practical financial matters, such as personal budgeting, taxes, credit and debt, and savings and investment, as well as various economic issues, such as those related to the underground economy, economic inequality, and consumer behaviour. Students will apply the concepts of economic thinking, the economic inquiry process, and economic models to investigate various economic issues and structures and to analyse the impact of economic decisions, including their own decisions, at the individual, community, and national levels.

Prerequisite: Canadian History since World War I, Grade 10, Academic or Applied, or the locally developed compulsory course (LDCC) in Canadian history

OVERVIEW

The course has five strands. Instruction and learning related to the expectations in strand A are to be interwoven with instruction and learning related to expectations from the other four strands. Strand A must not be seen as independent of the other strands. Student achievement of the expectations in strand A is to be assessed and evaluated *throughout* the course.

Strand A

A. Economic Inquiry and Skill Development
Overall Expectations
A1. Economic Inquiry: use the economic inquiry process and the concepts of economic thinking when investigating economic issues, including those related to personal economic choices
A2. Developing Transferable Skills: apply in everyday contexts skills developed through economic investigation, and identify some careers in which a background in economics might be an asset

(continued)

Overview *(continued)*

Throughout this course, when planning instruction, teachers should weave the expectations from strand A in with the expectations from strands B–E.

Strands B–E

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Economic Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
B. Developing Financial Literacy		
B1. Financial Goals and Financial Planning: explain how various factors can affect individuals' financial plans and goals (FOCUS ON: <i>Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective</i>)	Sound financial planning involves a number of key principles.	What is the difference between a need and a want? What factors can affect a person's financial goals?
B2. Savings, Credit, and Debt: demonstrate an understanding of some key considerations relating to savings, credit, and debt (FOCUS ON: <i>Economic Significance; Cause and Effect</i>)	Personal financial choices can affect an individual's ability to secure credit. There are positive and negative aspects to personal debt.	Why is it important to start saving early? Why is it important to understand different types of credit and debt?
B3. Taxes and Government Expenditures: explain some ways in which governments in Canada raise revenue, with particular emphasis on personal income tax, and analyse the purpose of government expenditures (FOCUS ON: <i>Economic Significance; Stability and Variability</i>)	Governments raise revenue in various ways. Some government expenditures are intended to address socio-economic inequality in Canada.	What are some key ways in which governments in Canada use tax revenue?
C. Economic Fundamentals		
C1. Scarcity and Choice: demonstrate an understanding of scarcity and some other key economic concepts, and analyse how they affect economic decision making (FOCUS ON: <i>Economic Significance; Stability and Variability</i>)	Scarcity is a basic economic problem.	What impact does scarcity have on your own and others' economic decisions? Why might stakeholders differ in their assessment of the costs and benefits of organized and unorganized labour?
C2. Understanding the Canadian Economy: demonstrate an understanding of some economic concepts and how they are related to key aspects of the Canadian economy (FOCUS ON: <i>Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective</i>)	Households, businesses, and governments all contribute to Canada's economy.	How do entrepreneurs contribute to the Canadian economy?
C3. The Role of Labour: analyse the role of labour in the Canadian economy (FOCUS ON: <i>Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective</i>)	Workers in Canada have both rights and responsibilities.	Why might different stakeholders have different perspectives on economic issues that affect the environment?
C4. Stakeholders' Views on Economic Issues: analyse a variety of economic issues from the perspectives of different stakeholders (FOCUS ON: <i>Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective</i>)	Different stakeholders can have different perspectives on economic issues.	

* See page 17 for a discussion of the purpose of big ideas and framing questions.

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Economic Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
D. Markets, Consumers, and Producers		
D1. Market Fundamentals: analyse, with reference to both producers and consumers, how a variety of factors affect markets (FOCUS ON: <i>Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective</i>)	There are many ways in which people can exchange goods and services. Markets are affected by supply and demand as well as by the decisions of consumers and producers.	How does scarcity affect the price of a product? How do producers create demand for their products? How do consumers affect the economy?
D2. Rights and Responsibilities of Consumers: describe key rights and responsibilities of consumers, as well as some significant aspects of consumer behaviour, and analyse their significance (FOCUS ON: <i>Economic Significance; Cause and Effect</i>)	Consumers have rights and responsibilities. Consumers' choices can affect the economy and the environment.	What are the responsibilities of businesses? How do government rules influence those responsibilities?
D3. Responsibilities of Producers: analyse some responsibilities and business practices of, and some regulations affecting, producers (FOCUS ON: <i>Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective</i>)	Government regulations help enforce the responsibilities of producers.	
E. Economies of Canadian Communities		
E1. Economic Inequality: analyse factors that contribute to, and programs that are intended to address, economic inequality in Canada (FOCUS ON: <i>Economic Significance; Stability and Variability</i>)	Wealth is not distributed equally among Canadians.	What are the main causes of poverty in Canada? How effective are government and business responses to economic inequality in Canada?
E2. Economic Variations among Canadian Communities: explain some of the causes and consequences of economic variations in different regions of Canada (FOCUS ON: <i>Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective</i>)	There are regional economic variations in Canada.	How does where you live affect your economic choices?
E3. The Local Economy: analyse some key aspects of the economy of their local community (FOCUS ON: <i>Economic Significance; Stability and Variability</i>)	Various factors can affect the economic health of the local community.	What are the economic realities in your community? What could be done to improve them?

A. ECONOMIC INQUIRY AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATION

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Economic Inquiry:** use the economic inquiry process and the concepts of economic thinking when investigating economic issues, including those related to personal economic choices;
- A2. Developing Transferable Skills:** apply in everyday contexts skills developed through economic investigation, and identify some careers in which a background in economics might be an asset.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Economic Inquiry

Throughout this course, students will:

A1.1 formulate different types of questions to guide investigations into economic issues, including those related to personal economic choices (e.g., factual questions: *What types of financial institutions exist in Canada?*; comparative questions: *Would it be better for me to put my money in a chequing account, a savings account, or a guaranteed investment certificate?*; causal questions: *How can my choices as a consumer affect the environment?*)

A1.2 select and organize relevant data, evidence, and information on economic issues, including those related to personal economic choices, from primary and secondary sources (e.g., primary: *bank or credit card statements, contracts or agreements for online products/services, interviews, pay stubs, statistics*; secondary: *advertisements, business reports, documentary films, news articles, textbooks, websites of companies or consumer groups*), ensuring that their sources reflect different perspectives

Sample questions: “What information can you obtain from a pay stub?” “Where could you find information on interest rates offered by various financial institutions?” “What information might be included in the ‘fine print’ of a financial agreement/contract?”

A1.3 assess the credibility of sources relevant to their investigations (e.g., *by considering how the data or information was constructed; the accuracy, purpose, and/or context of the source; the intended audience; the bias, values, and/or expertise of the author*)

Sample questions: “What is the purpose of this advertisement? Do you think that purpose affects the credibility of the claims made by the ad?”

A1.4 interpret and analyse data, evidence, and information relevant to their investigations, using various tools, strategies, and approaches appropriate for economic inquiry (e.g., *create a chart to help them compare the services offered by various financial institutions; use a line graph to help them analyse housing costs in two different cities; analyse data to determine the short- and long-term costs of renting and buying*)

A1.5 use the concepts of economic thinking (i.e., economic significance, cause and effect, stability and variability, and economic perspective) when analysing and evaluating data, evidence, and information and formulating conclusions and/or judgements about economic issues, including those related to personal economic choices (e.g., *take the concept of economic significance into consideration when determining the impact of rising gas prices on personal finances; use the concept of cause and effect when analysing intended and unintended consequences of government involvement in the economy; take the concept of stability and variability into consideration when determining what types of personal investments to make in different economic circumstances; use the concept of economic perspective to help them explain why some stakeholders might promote industrial development in a community while others might discourage it*)

Sample questions: “What concept or concepts of economic thinking might be most relevant to an analysis of the issue of fair trade? Why?” “Why might applying the concept of cause and

effect help you understand why an individual might get a payday loan and the impact of that loan on his or her finances?" "Why is the concept of economic perspective particularly relevant when investigating issues related to supply and demand?"

- A1.6** evaluate and synthesize their findings to formulate conclusions and/or make informed judgements and/or predictions about the economic issues they are investigating

Sample questions: "What have you concluded about how your needs and wants affect your spending habits? Do you think your findings will have an impact on your behaviour? Why or why not?"

- A1.7** communicate their ideas, arguments, and conclusions using various formats and styles, as appropriate for the audience and purpose (e.g., a presentation, including visual elements, on how a particular business contributes to their community; a letter of complaint to the appropriate party regarding a defective product; an information session for the school on the impact of the underground economy; a debate on the merits of renting versus buying a home; a graph showing the cost of compound interest on outstanding credit card charges; a video on the use of tax dollars in their community; a blog on a controversial economic issue)

- A1.8** use accepted forms of documentation (e.g., footnotes or endnotes, author/date citations, reference lists, bibliographies, credits) to reference different types of sources (e.g., articles, books, film or videos, interviews, websites)

- A1.9** use appropriate terminology when communicating the results of their investigations (e.g., vocabulary specific to their inquiry topics; terminology related to economics and the concepts of economic thinking)

A2. Developing Transferable Skills

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** describe ways in which economic investigations can help them develop skills, including the essential skills in the Ontario Skills Passport (e.g., skills related to oral communication, reading text, computer use, numeracy, decision making) and skills related to financial literacy, that can be transferred to the world of work and/or to everyday life

- A2.2** apply in everyday contexts skills and work habits developed through economic investigations (e.g., apply skills to interact respectfully with people in different contexts, to identify bias in a blog or other source, to help them make informed consumer choices; demonstrate work habits such as teamwork by cooperating with others to organize an event in the community, or reliability by following instructions in the classroom or at their part-time job)

- A2.3** apply the concepts of economic thinking when analysing current events involving economic issues (e.g., job cuts at a company in a small community; government aid to a large corporation; a report on corruption in a company operating in the developing world; a current issue facing workers in an offshore textile company or migrant workers in Canada; announcements regarding the latest unemployment rate; a strike) in order to enhance their understanding of these events and their role as informed citizens

Sample questions: "Why is this company closing? What impact will its closing have on workers and their families? What impact will it have on the local or regional economy?"

- A2.4** identify some careers in which the skills learned in economics might be useful (e.g., charitable foundation worker, customer service representative, entrepreneur, farmer, financial assistant, human resources representative, manager of or clerk in a cooperative)

B. DEVELOPING FINANCIAL LITERACY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Financial Goals and Financial Planning:** explain how various factors can affect individuals' financial plans and goals (**FOCUS ON:** *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*)
- B2. Savings, Credit, and Debt:** demonstrate an understanding of some key considerations relating to savings, credit, and debt (**FOCUS ON:** *Economic Significance; Cause and Effect*)
- B3. Taxes and Government Expenditures:** explain some ways in which governments in Canada raise revenue, with particular emphasis on personal income tax, and analyse the purpose of government expenditures (**FOCUS ON:** *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Financial Goals and Financial Planning

FOCUS ON: *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** describe some ways in which individuals' personal resources (*e.g., education, employability skills, financial resources, inherited resources, time*) and values can affect their financial goals

Sample questions: "What is the difference between a need and a want? How might people's values affect their wants or the ways in which they satisfy their needs?" "How might someone's personal values affect whether he or she gives money to charities and, if so, which charities he or she supports?" "Why should a person consider his or her skills when setting financial goals?" "In what ways are your own financial goals influenced by your personal resources? Do you think these resources will change over time?"

- B1.2** explain some of the key principles of sound financial planning (*e.g., start saving early, set realistic and measurable goals, prioritize, diversify*)

Sample questions: "What are the advantages of an early start to saving? What impact can an early start have on a registered education savings plan [RESP] or registered retirement savings plan [RRSP]?" "Why might buying insurance – life insurance, home owners' insurance, and/or health insurance – be a component of a person's financial plan?" "What are the benefits of having a weekly savings plan? How can such a plan

support short- and long-term personal financial goals?"

- B1.3** compare wages, salaries, and benefits typically offered in different types of employment (*e.g., full-time, part-time, and contract employment; apprenticeships; service, sales, and/or professional positions; unionized and non-unionized jobs; base salary and commissions, tips, and/or bonuses*), and explain some ways in which they might affect individuals' financial planning

Sample questions: "Why is it important to consider benefits such as pensions, medical and dental plans, and paid vacations when comparing the financial rewards for full-time and contract employment?" "What is the difference between gross and net income? What types of deductions typically appear on a pay stub?" "If an employee is enrolled in a company pension plan, how might this affect his or her short- and/or long-term financial planning?"

- B1.4** explain how some economic and/or social factors (*e.g., wage rates/salaries, inflation, tax brackets, cost of living in the local community, exchange rates*) can affect the purchasing power of individuals

Sample questions: "How might an increase in fuel prices affect an individual's ability to finance a holiday?" "When a car manufacturer offers rebates on new cars, who benefits from such deals? Who does not?" "How can the fees charged by payday loan companies affect the purchasing power of people who use these institutions?"

B1.5 explain how some financial variables (e.g., *income, deductions, fixed expenses, investments, savings, credit, interest rates*) can affect individuals' personal budgets in the short, medium, and long term

Sample questions: "What does the term 'house poor' mean? Why might the fixed expenses associated with buying a house affect a family's short-term budgets?" "When thinking about long-term budgets, why is it important to consider possible fluctuations in interest rates?" "What is the difference between a fixed- and variable-rate mortgage? Why might a person choose one over the other?"

B1.6 explain key considerations related to preparing a personal budget (e.g., *the need to have an accurate sense of one's personal financial resources, to distinguish between needs and wants, to prioritize wants and balance them against limited resources, to factor in costs of borrowing*), and apply them when creating their own personal budget

Sample questions: "Are you able to cover all your needs in your budget? If there are resources left over, how will you decide the best way to allocate them? Will you allocate money for savings in your budget? Why or why not?"

B2. Savings, Credit, and Debt

FOCUS ON: *Economic Significance; Cause and Effect*

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 compare key features of different types of financial institutions (e.g., *banks, including online banks; credit unions; insurance companies; companies offering payday loans; brokerage firms*), with a particular focus on the services they offer

Sample questions: "What are the major differences between banks and credit unions in Ontario? Are there services that banks offer that credit unions do not?" "What are some different types of accounts offered by financial institutions? What are some of the advantages and disadvantages of each?"

B2.2 compare key aspects of different types of credit (e.g., *credit cards, lines of credit, personal loans such as payday loans or car loans, mortgages, business loans*), and describe criteria that financial institutions use to determine whether a person is creditworthy (e.g., *capital, character, capacity, collateral*)

Sample questions: "What are the costs of a payday loan compared to a loan from a bank? Despite its costs, why might some people seek

a payday loan rather than getting a bank loan?" "Why is the interest rate on unpaid balances on credit cards higher than the interest rates on mortgages?" "What would a bank consider when assessing the capacity of a loan applicant to repay the loan?" "What might be some of the unintended consequences of having a credit card?"

B2.3 explain some positive and negative aspects of debt (e.g., *loans enable a person to pay for costly items, such as tuition, a vehicle, or a home, over time; a good credit rating enhances a person's ability to secure a personal loan at a good rate of interest; too much debt can lead to a poor credit rating or to bankruptcy*)

Sample questions: "What types of behaviour can affect a person's credit rating?" "What factors have the biggest influence on your own credit rating? Are there financial decisions that you have made or are facing now that might affect your credit rating? Why is it important to consider the long-term consequences of these decisions?" "What criteria should a person use in deciding whether to save for or get a loan to purchase an expensive item?"

B2.4 describe some factors (e.g., *liquidity, rate of return, risk, disposable income, age*) that influence individuals' decisions about preferred types of savings and investments (e.g., *tax-free savings accounts, guaranteed investment certificates [GICs], bonds, stocks, RESPs, RRSPs*)

Sample questions: "What are the advantages and disadvantages of investing in a stock, buying a GIC, or saving money under your mattress?" "Why might the decisions you make now with respect to savings be different from those your parents are making?" "What level of risk is associated with different types of investments?"

B3. Taxes and Government Expenditures

FOCUS ON: *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 describe some key aspects of personal income tax in Canada (e.g., *tax brackets, child tax benefits, deductions for charitable/political donations, tax deferral with RRSPs, penalties for late or unfiled taxes*), and analyse their purpose

Sample questions: "What is the purpose of allowing individuals to deduct RRSP contributions when they file their income tax returns?"

How might this program contribute to individual and/or governmental financial stability?" "What is the government's purpose in imposing higher tax rates on individuals with higher net incomes?"

B3.2 explain some of the ways in which different levels of government in Canada raise revenue (e.g., *income tax, sales tax, GST/HST, property tax, excise tax, fees for some services*), and analyse how and why they spend these revenues (e.g., *on transit, garbage collection, parks and community centres, roads, education, health care, the military, Old Age Security, tax incentives for some environmental programs, incentives for industries/corporations*)

Sample questions: "What are some ways in which governments invest in infrastructure? Why are such investments important for the economy?" "What is the purpose of environmental tax incentives? Do you think they are effective at influencing people's behaviour?" "What are some ways in which government spending affects your daily life?"

B3.3 analyse the contribution of taxation and government expenditures to socio-economic equality in Canada (e.g., *with reference to progressive income tax rates; use of revenues for both universal and means-tested social programs such as medicare, Old Age Security, social assistance*)

Sample questions: "Why do governments tax some food products and not others?" "What role do tax dollars have in funding your school? Recreation centres in your community? Social assistance for those in need? What contribution do such expenditures make to socio-economic equality?"

C. ECONOMIC FUNDAMENTALS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Scarcity and Choice:** demonstrate an understanding of scarcity and some other key economic concepts, and analyse how they affect economic decision making (**FOCUS ON:** *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*)
- C2. Understanding the Canadian Economy:** demonstrate an understanding of some economic concepts and how they are related to key aspects of the Canadian economy (**FOCUS ON:** *Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective*)
- C3. The Role of Labour:** analyse the role of labour in the Canadian economy (**FOCUS ON:** *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*)
- C4. Stakeholders' Views on Economic Issues:** analyse a variety of economic issues from the perspectives of different stakeholders (**FOCUS ON:** *Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Scarcity and Choice

FOCUS ON: *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the economic concepts of scarcity, trade-offs, and opportunity costs, analysing how they apply to various economic decisions, including some of their own decisions (*e.g., with reference to allocating time, money, and skills; prioritizing their needs and wants while considering their limited resources; calculating the opportunity costs of different decisions*)

Sample questions: "What do economists mean when they talk about 'scarcity'? In what ways do you see this concept at work in your own life?" "What do people mean when they say 'There is no such thing as a free lunch'? What is the significance of this saying in economics?" "What are the trade-offs of working part time while going to school rather than having a full-time job?" "How might a community weigh the opportunity costs of a decision to turn an area into parkland rather than zoning it for business or residential use?"

- C1.2** analyse the interrelationship between scarcity, their needs and wants, and their personal values

Sample questions: "How do your personal values influence the criteria you use when determining what you do with your pay cheque? How might your choices change if you received a raise or lost your job?"

C2. Understanding the Canadian Economy

FOCUS ON: *Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of economic inputs (i.e., the resources of land, labour, capital, and entrepreneurship) and outputs (i.e., goods and services) and their role in Canada's economy

Sample questions: "Should unpaid housework be included in official measures of economic inputs or outputs? Why or why not?" "How do a country's natural resources influence labour opportunities?"

- C2.2** compare key characteristics of market, mixed, traditional, and command economies, and analyse their significance for different groups

Sample questions: "What economic system does Canada have? What are some of the advantages and disadvantages of this system?" "Why might an entrepreneur prefer to do business in a market economy rather than a command economy?"

C2.3 apply the circular flow model to analyse interactions between key components of Canada's economy (e.g., households, businesses, governments)

Sample questions: "How are the components of Canada's economy connected to each other? How does money flow between these components?" "What might be the impact of a smaller role for the government in the economy?"

C2.4 describe common business organization models in Canada (e.g., sole proprietorship, partnership, cooperative, corporation), and analyse some of their advantages and disadvantages

Sample questions: "Why might someone choose to join others in forming a cooperative rather than form a sole proprietorship?" "What are some of the factors to consider when determining whether to enter into a business partnership?"

C2.5 describe different ways in which governments are involved in the Canadian economy (e.g., as consumers, regulators, producers, employers, redistributors of income, tax/tariff collectors, quota setters, trade negotiators), and explain some of the effects of this involvement

Sample questions: "What is the role of government transfer payments in Canada?" "Why does the provincial government require drivers to have car insurance? What impact, if any, does this requirement have on you?" "What are some employment opportunities with the local, provincial, and/or federal government?"

C3. The Role of Labour

FOCUS ON: Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 describe some key rights and responsibilities of labour (e.g., the right to fair compensation, to fair hiring/firing practices, to safe working conditions, to organize and bargain collectively, to a harassment-free workplace; the responsibility to comply with regulations, to alert the employer to safety hazards)

Sample questions: "What action should a worker take if he or she has been asked to work on damaged or unsafe equipment?" "What type of behaviour constitutes harassment in the workplace? How should a worker respond to such behaviour?"

C3.2 describe some ways in which labour organizes in Canada as well as some categories of unorganized labour (e.g., with reference to

professional associations, labour unions, non-unionized labour, worker-run cooperatives, itinerant workers, temporary foreign workers), and analyse some of the advantages and disadvantages of organized and unorganized labour from the perspective of different stakeholders (e.g., workers, business, governments, consumers)

Sample question: "Why might workers and corporations have different views on unions?"

C3.3 explain how various factors contribute to the value of the individual in the employment market (e.g., productivity; skills, including language and technical skills; education; talent; supply and demand; employers' assumptions related to race, gender, and/or sexual orientation)

Sample questions: "What types of jobs are available in our community? Why types of skills are needed for these jobs?" "What are some factors that can hurt a person's chances of finding a job?"

C3.4 analyse the characteristics of some Canadian entrepreneurs as well as the role of entrepreneurs in the Canadian economy (e.g., First Nations or youth entrepreneurs, small-business people, individuals such as Arlene Dickinson, Clarence Louie, Tom Maracle, Michael Lee-Chin)

Sample questions: "What characteristics do many entrepreneurs seem to have in common? Why do you think that is?" "How important is the role played by entrepreneurs in the Canadian economy?"

C4. Stakeholders' Views on Economic Issues

FOCUS ON: Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective

By the end of this course, students will:

C4.1 describe the main differences between the public and the private sector, and explain some of the advantages and disadvantages of privatizing public services and/or Crown corporations in Canada (e.g., Canada Post, Ontario Hydro, Via Rail, the Liquor Control Board of Ontario)

Sample questions: "What are some Crown corporations that have been privatized? Do you think their privatization was a good idea? Why or why not? Why might different stakeholders have different perspectives on this issue?" "If the Canadian Broadcasting Corporation were privatized, do you think the impact would be the same in northern Ontario as it would be in southern Ontario?"

C4.2 analyse some key economic issues related to Canada's natural resources from the perspective of different stakeholders (*e.g., extracting and transporting oil and natural gas; the marketing of asbestos overseas; the use and protection of Canada's water; resource development and Aboriginal land claims; resource extraction in national parks*)

Sample question: "Why might beverage companies, retailers, environmentalists, and different levels of government have differing perspectives on the bottling and selling of water?"

C4.3 explain why various stakeholders might have different views of the costs and benefits of a project affecting the local natural environment (*e.g., a proposal for an energy pipeline, a resource-extraction or -processing proposal, an alternative energy project, highway expansion, a new housing*

or commercial development, the expansion of public transit, a new skateboard park)

Sample questions: "Why might a community agree to have a new landfill site in the area? What might be the benefits for the community? Would all stakeholders benefit, or benefit equally? What might be the costs? Would all stakeholders calculate the costs the same way?" "How might different stakeholders view the costs and benefits of logging a forest in a particular area? Why might some groups, including local Aboriginal communities, believe that not all costs are considered in a traditional cost-benefit analysis of such activity?"

D. MARKETS, CONSUMERS, AND PRODUCERS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Market Fundamentals:** analyse, with reference to both producers and consumers, how a variety of factors affect markets (**FOCUS ON:** *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*)
- D2. Rights and Responsibilities of Consumers:** describe key rights and responsibilities of consumers, as well as some significant aspects of consumer behaviour, and analyse their significance (**FOCUS ON:** *Economic Significance; Cause and Effect*)
- D3. Responsibilities of Producers:** analyse some responsibilities and business practices of, and some regulations affecting, producers (**FOCUS ON:** *Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Market Fundamentals

FOCUS ON: *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** analyse differences in the perspectives of producers and consumers in the market with respect to supply and demand (*e.g., how a drought affecting wheat farmers in western Canada might affect producers and consumers; how producers influence demand; how demand and availability can affect prices; how producers are influenced by technology*)
Sample questions: “How could you use a supply and demand graph to explain fluctuations in the price of gasoline?” “What role does scarcity play in the price of a product? What are some factors that can contribute to the scarcity of a product or resource?” “How and why do producers try to create demand for products?” “How can consumers influence the market through boycotts or social media?” “How might a change in technology affect the supply of a product? Do you see this at work in your own life?”
- D1.2** explain how and why producers and consumers participate in grey and black markets (*e.g., to avoid taxes, fees, and/or regulations; to avoid paying for, or to pay less for, products or services; to maximize limited resources; to trade services without exchanging money*), and analyse some consequences of participation in these

markets (*e.g., copyright infringement results in lack of fair compensation to people in cultural industries; less tax revenue results in reduced funds available for government services; piracy or income tax evasion can result in fines; work done “under the table” is not regulated and may result in substandard work or safety risks; undocumented workers may not be fairly compensated and may not be protected by labour laws*)

Sample questions: “What are some of the consequences of tax evasion for individuals and governments?” “Why is it important to be documented on an employer’s payroll as opposed to being paid under the table?” “What is the economic impact of the illegal downloading of music or movies?”

- D1.3** explain how various factors can influence consumers’ decisions, including their own decisions (*e.g., price, income, availability of other similar products/services, status associated with products, personal values, loyalty programs, coupons, financing offered by retailers, sales promotions, availability of products online, advertising and promotion*)

Sample questions: “Have you ever bought something on impulse because it was on sale?” “What impact do advertising and the entertainment industry have on consumer preferences? Have they influenced your own personal consumer choices?” “What factors might affect a person’s decision about whether to rent an apartment or buy a house or condo?” “Are you

enrolled in any loyalty/points programs? Do they have an impact on your decisions as a consumer?"

D1.4 analyse how changes in technology have affected ways in which people conduct financial and consumer transactions (*e.g., online banks and online banking services; e-tail; ways of paying for online purchases, including online transfer of funds, electronic gift cards; group coupons*)

Sample questions: "What are the benefits and potential risks for consumers of buying online?" "In what ways has the Internet affected consumer and/or producer practices? How has it affected your own behaviour as a consumer?"

D2. Rights and Responsibilities of Consumers

FOCUS ON: *Economic Significance; Cause and Effect*

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 identify key rights of consumers (*e.g., truth in advertising, protection from hazardous products, warnings about potential dangers associated with improper use of products*) and possible recourse when these rights are infringed (*e.g., returning the product to the producer or the point of purchase, writing a letter of complaint, reporting the problem to the relevant government department, using social media to alert others to the problem and/or to campaign for the producer to change its practices*)

Sample questions: "Have you ever bought a product or service that was not as advertised? What action did you take? If you complained, were you satisfied with the response(s)?" "What types of consumer protection are legislated by the Ontario government?"

D2.2 identify key responsibilities of consumers (*e.g., contractual obligations; the responsibility to make informed decisions, read and follow product information and instructions, use and dispose of products safely*), and analyse their significance

Sample questions: "What do you think are the most important consumer responsibilities? Why? What would happen if consumers did not respect those responsibilities?" "What do you do to ensure that you are a responsible consumer?"

D2.3 explain how various consumer choices can affect the natural environment (*e.g., with reference to buying local, cruelty-free, or organic products; buying unsustainable seafood; buying bulk goods to reduce packaging; disposing of old electronics in landfill; buying Energy Star appliances;*

boycotting companies that are environmentally irresponsible)

Sample questions: "In what ways do the consumer choices that you make affect the environment? What could you do to make your choices more environmentally sustainable?" "What do you do with your old cellphones, music devices, or computers? What impact do you think your method of disposal has on the environment?"

D2.4 explain why some Canadian consumers shop in the United States, and analyse the economic significance of this activity (*e.g., for consumers, Canadian-owned businesses, governments*)

Sample questions: "In what ways might Canadians who do not live in a border town be affected by cross-border shopping?" "Why have some Canadian companies decided to hold 'Black Friday' sales?" "How does the value of the Canadian dollar in relation to the American dollar affect cross-border shopping?"

D2.5 explain some of the advantages and disadvantages of buying and selling fair-trade products (*e.g., these products tend to be more expensive but pay a fairer price to producers in developing countries, promote sustainable development, and support healthy working conditions*)

Sample questions: "What are the ideas behind the fair-trade movement? How successful do you think it has been in accomplishing its goals?" "Why might people choose not to buy fair trade items?" "How can you be sure that the products you buy were not made using child labour?"

D3. Responsibilities of Producers

FOCUS ON: *Stability and Variability; Economic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 analyse the responsibilities of employers with regard to various stakeholders (*e.g., to provide a safe workplace, to comply with government regulations, to make a profit for shareholders, to act in a socially responsible way*)

Sample questions: "Do you think a corporation's responsibility to its shareholders outweighs its responsibilities to other stakeholders? Why or why not?" "What are the key differences between for-profit and not-for-profit corporations?" "What is a social enterprise? In what ways might it be different from a typical corporation?"

D3.2 describe some unethical and/or illegal business practices (*e.g., bribery, insider trading, disregarding environmental or other regulations*), and explain why they occur

Sample questions: “What was the immediate cause of the collapse of the Rana Plaza garment factory in Bangladesh in 2013? What business practices contributed to this event? What do you think needs to happen to prevent tragedies like this from happening again?” “Why does the Competition Bureau monitor and investigate price fixing and bid rigging in Canada?”

D3.3 identify some government regulations that affect producers (*e.g., regulations related to labour mobility, labelling, the environment, minimum wages, worker health and safety, accessibility, hazardous materials, foreign ownership*), and assess the impact of regulations on different stakeholders (*e.g., consumers, employees, employers, environmentalists*)

Sample questions: “Why might producers want fewer government regulations?” “What are some regulations that affect the mobility of skilled labour? Why are they in place? What are some positive and negative aspects of these regulations?” “Do you think voluntary codes or regulations work? Why or why not?”

E. ECONOMIES OF CANADIAN COMMUNITIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Economic Inequality:** analyse factors that contribute to, and programs that are intended to address, economic inequality in Canada (**FOCUS ON:** *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*)
- E2. Economic Variations among Canadian Communities:** explain some of the causes and consequences of economic variations in different regions of Canada (**FOCUS ON:** *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*)
- E3. The Local Economy:** analyse some key aspects of the economy of their local community (**FOCUS ON:** *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Economic Inequality

FOCUS ON: *Economic Significance; Stability and Variability*

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** analyse how various factors contribute to poverty in Canada (e.g., gender, race, language, social background, wage rates, unemployment rates, lack of job opportunities in certain regions, outsourcing of jobs as a result of globalization, lack of affordable housing, inadequate education, increase in single-parent families)
Sample questions: “What factors do you think have the greatest influence on who is poor in Canada?” “What impact would an increase in the minimum wage have on the working poor in Ontario?”
- E1.2** describe, and assess the effectiveness of, some programs and services that are intended to address economic inequality in Canada (e.g., minimum wages, social assistance, employment insurance, pensions, public education, universal health care, public housing programs, Habitat for Humanity, Goodwill, skills retraining, microcredit or social finance initiatives, new business grants, food banks)
Sample questions: “Which programs/services do you think are the most effective in addressing economic inequality in Canada? Do you think these programs/services are adequate? If not, what more do you think should be done?”

- E1.3** explain some ways in which producers can affect economic inequality in Canada (e.g., by providing well-paying jobs, by paying their taxes, by supporting food banks and other community programs to address the needs of those living in poverty, by closing factories and moving jobs outside Canada, by hiring temporary foreign workers)

Sample questions: “Why have some Canadian companies moved their operations abroad or hired temporary workers from other countries? What impact have such practices had on Canadian workers and the Canadian economy?” “What impact would the closing of a major manufacturing company in a small town have on employment and community resources?”

E2. Economic Variations among Canadian Communities

FOCUS ON: *Cause and Effect; Economic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- E2.1** compare the prices of consumer goods in different regions of Canada, and explain the main causes of regional variation (e.g., availability of goods within the region, transportation costs to relatively remote communities, market size)
Sample questions: “What factors influence differences in food prices between Hamilton, Ontario, and St. John’s, Newfoundland?” “Why might the cost of housing in a region be an indicator of the general economic health of that region?”

E2.2 explain how some economic variables can affect the cost of living in various communities in Canada (e.g., with reference to employment levels, types of work available, scarcity of housing, types of community services)

Sample question: “Why is the cost of living different in Vancouver than in Windsor?”

E2.3 identify some reasons for variations in employment rates between communities (e.g., proximity of communities to natural resources; jobs moving offshore; changes in demand for a particular product; availability of infrastructure to attract business; the closing or downsizing of a plant)

Sample questions: “What are some regions or communities in Canada that have high unemployment rates? Why are the rates higher in these communities than in other areas? Why are unemployment rates on some First Nations reserves higher than in most other communities in Canada?” “What are some strategies that different communities with high unemployment rates are using to try to boost employment?”

E3. The Local Economy

FOCUS ON: Economic Significance; Stability and Variability

By the end of this course, students will:

E3.1 explain the impact, both positive and negative, that businesses can have on a community, with reference, where possible, to their local community (e.g., providing employment; sponsoring sports teams, cultural events, or other community groups/projects; environmental damage; impact of layoffs or the use of temporary foreign workers)

Sample questions: “Why might a business decide to support a local charity, cultural event, or sports team? What types of things do businesses support in your community? What impact does this have on the community?” “What are some of the major employers in your community? Do they provide good and secure jobs?”

E3.2 assess the availability of employment opportunities in their local community

Sample questions: “What opportunities do you have as a student for part-time employment in your community? What opportunities do you think you would have for full-time employment in your community after you graduate?”

E3.3 analyse how various factors, including the influence of different stakeholders, affect decisions with respect to infrastructure in their community (e.g., with reference to limited financial resources, the needs and wants of different citizens groups and businesses, the concerns/interests of politicians from different levels of government or with different political perspectives, environmental considerations)

Sample questions: “What aspects of the infrastructure need to be upgraded in your community? Which of these do you think should take priority? Why? Who might have a different perspective on priorities? Why?”

E3.4 explain how their actions can contribute to the economic health of their local community (e.g., buying local products, supporting local businesses, volunteering at a food bank, getting a job with a local company)

Sample questions: “How might your decision to buy locally produced goods affect your community? What other actions could you take to support the local economy?”